

6.2 Format a drive

Formatting a hard drive removes viruses and Trojans, and resolves other storage and hard-to-solve issues. However, ensure that you back up your important data, as the formatting process will wipe out all the data on the drive. The procedure to format the hard drive depends on whether you want to format the secondary hard drive, or the primary hard drive and install an operating system on it. Using third party software, i.e. tools other than the Windows system management tool, you may be able to format only secondary drives. The format which such applications offer is either a low-level format or a permanent erase.

It is important to back up all your data before you proceed. Be sure to back up all important data before engaging in any Formatting operation. Also, the possibility of damage to the hard disk cannot be ruled out. Due the a low-level format is an irreversible procedure, is not recommended to use on a regular basis, but only in extreme cases and as a last resort to recover a disk with problems such as bad sectors. So it goes without saying that it is not recommended to use the low-level format on new disks.

Hard Disk Low Level Format Tool from hddguru.com is one such tool that does what the name suggests: Low level formatting. Low-level formatting is the process of outlining the positions of the tracks and sectors on the hard disk, and writing the control structures that define where the tracks and sectors are. This type of formatting operation defines structures that tell where the data is stored on the disk. If a low level format is done on a disk with data on it already, the data is permanently erased.

On launching the application, it automatically scans the system and detects the available hard disks, which includes external drives. The tool supports IDE / SATA / SCSI, RAID arrays, external USB / Firewire hard disks,



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